

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

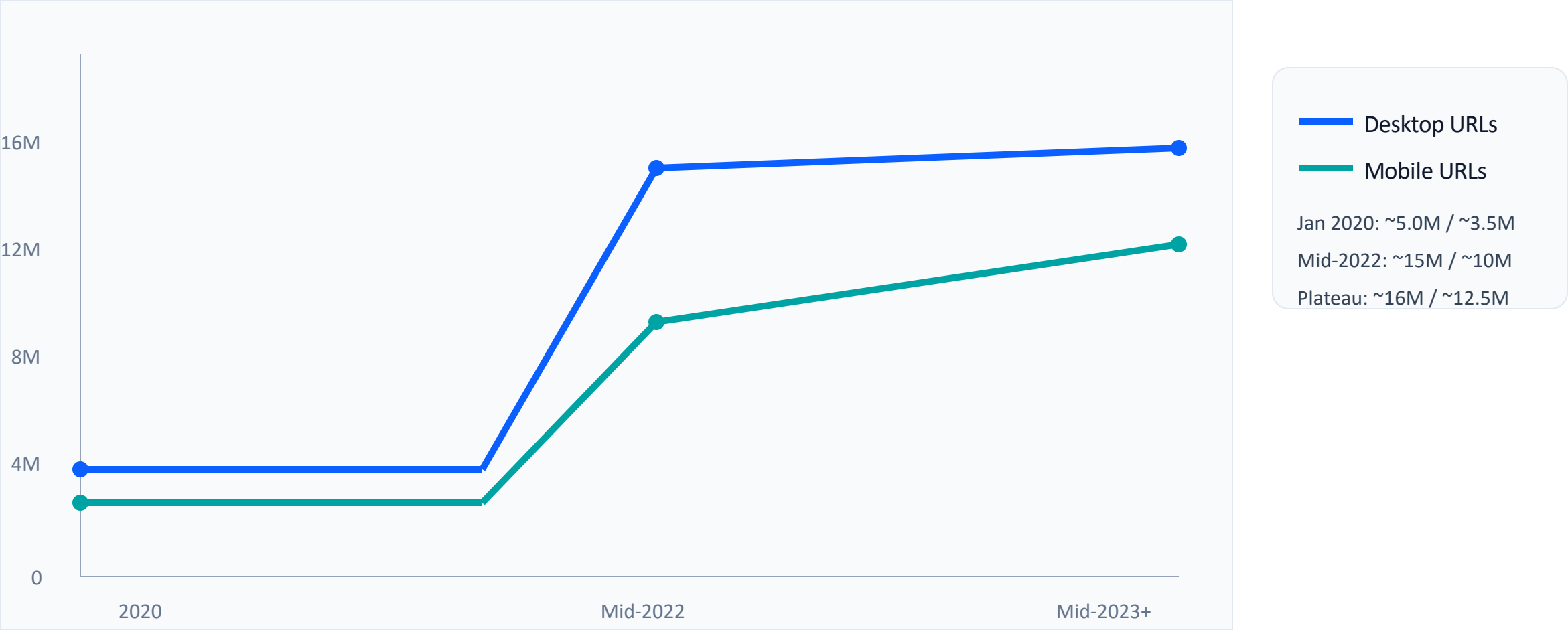
Tracking page complexity, transport efficiency, and security defaults

Data Source HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report

Time Range: Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

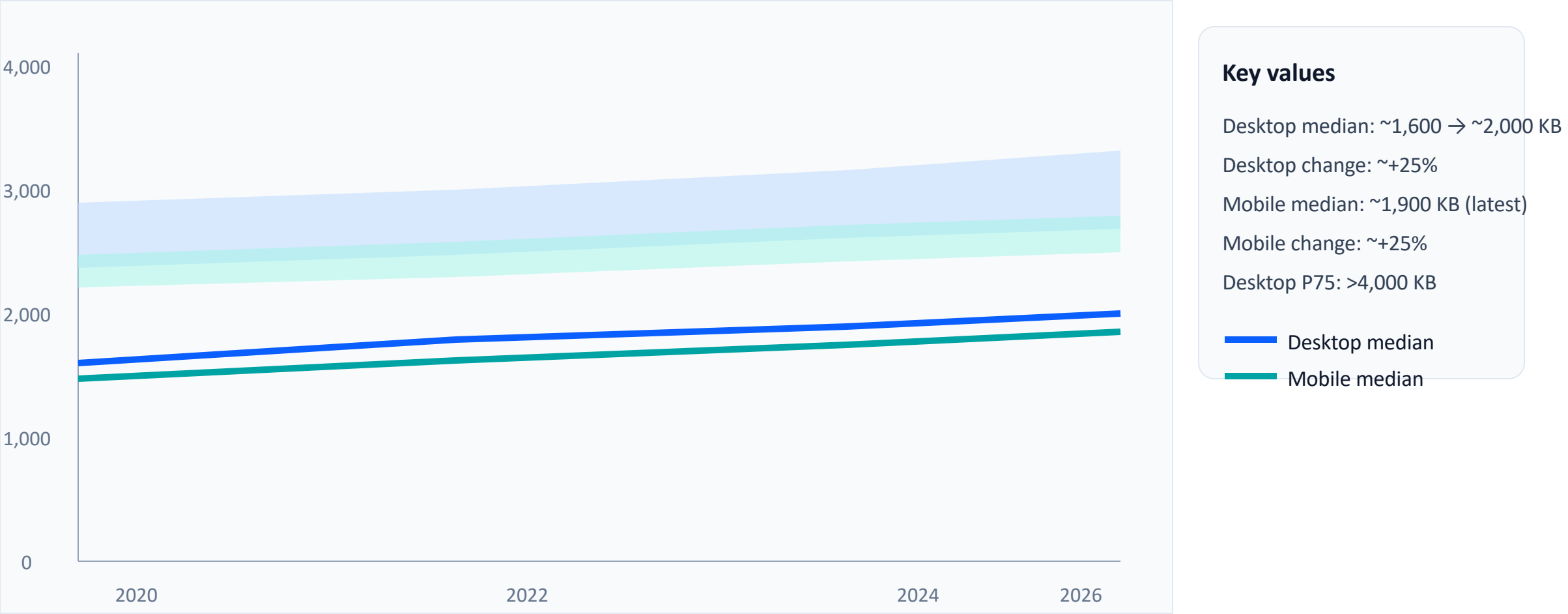
HTTP Archive crawl scope expanded sharply in mid-2022, then stabilized at a larger baseline.



Insight: A larger, stable crawl sample improves confidence in cross-year infrastructure trend comparisons.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Desktop median rose ~25% since early 2020; mobile follows closely with slightly lower totals.



Insight: Distribution spread remains large, with heavy-page outliers continuing to drive tail risk.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

More objects fetched per page, but fewer TCP connections needed due to multiplexing.

Total Requests / Page (Median)

76 Desktop

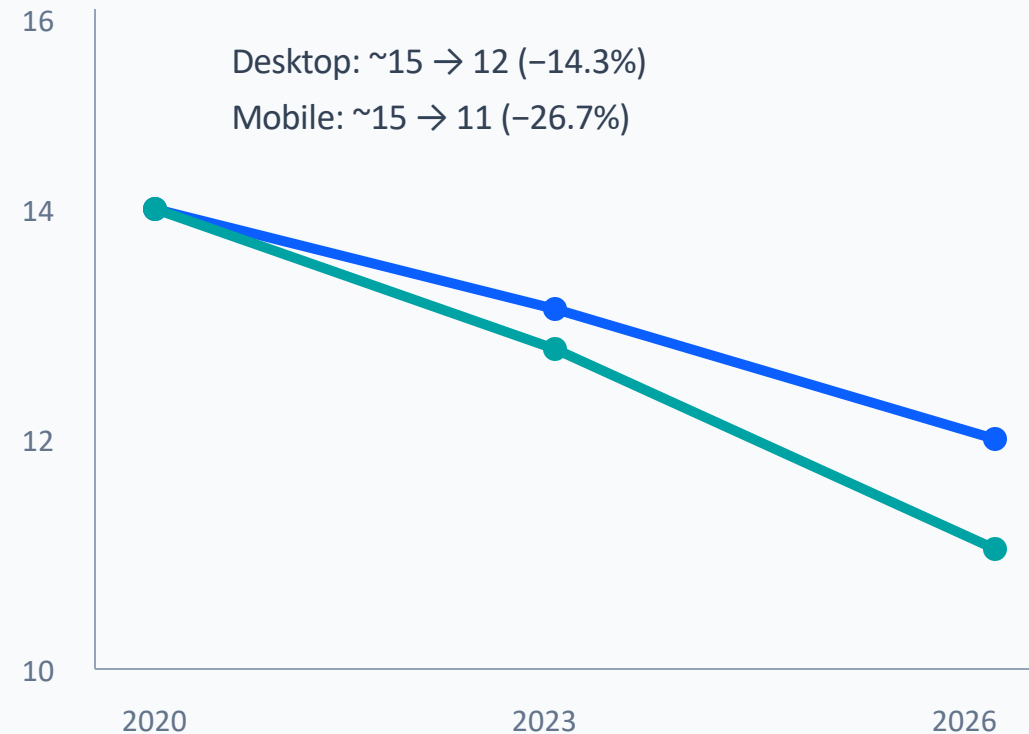
71 Mobile

Change vs 2020:

Desktop: +2.7% Mobile: +2.9%

Interpretation: request growth is modest,
but still adds pressure on bytes and CPU.

TCP Connections / Page (Median)



Efficiency gain: HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing sustain higher request volume with fewer concurrent transport connections.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

From ~80% in early 2020 to 99%+ today across desktop and mobile traffic.

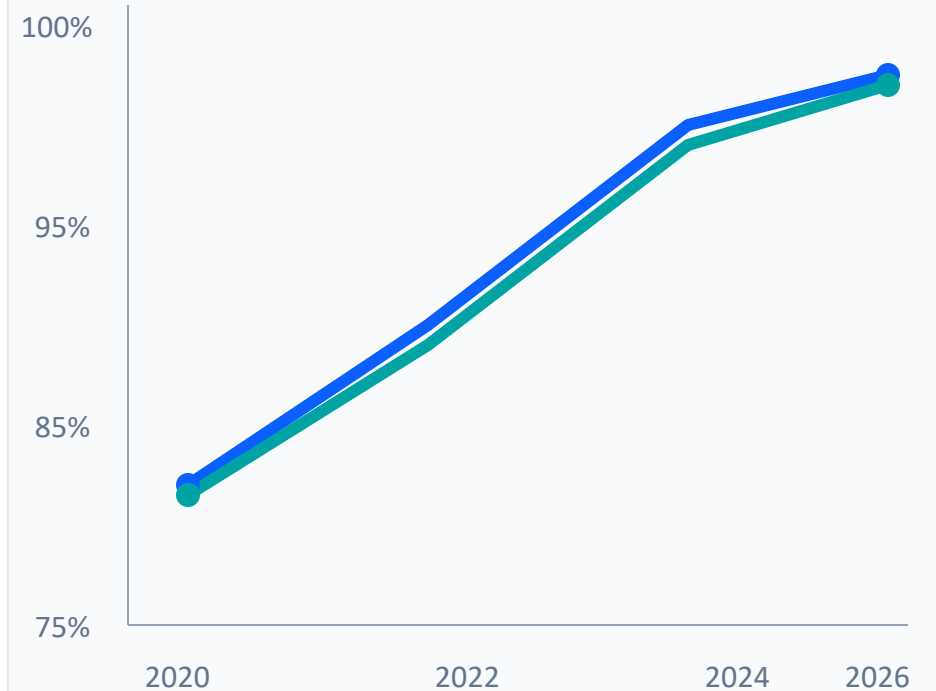
HTTPS Share

99%+

Desktop: 99.2% Mobile: 99.1%

Increase since 2020: roughly +19–20 pts

HTTPS adoption trend

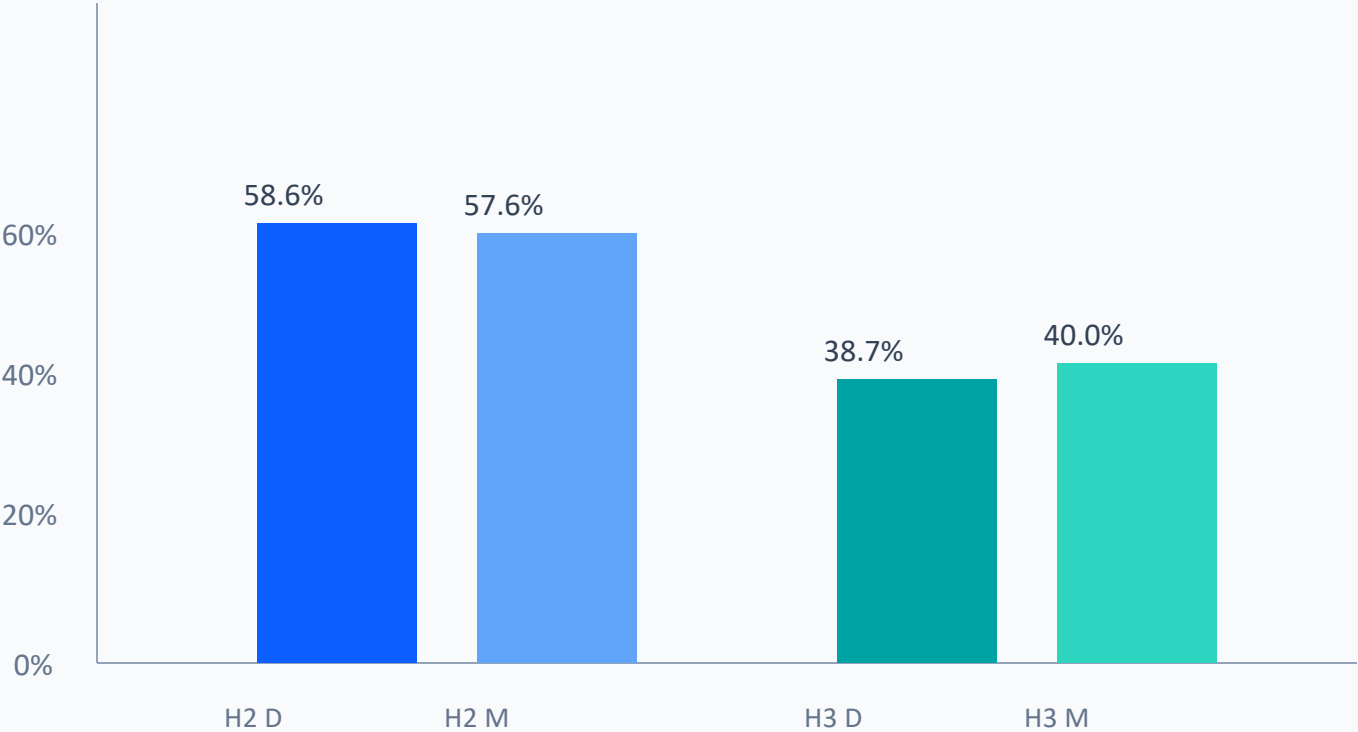


Operational implication: treat plaintext HTTP as exception handling, not a mainstream delivery path.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

Protocol stack is in transition: HTTP/2 remains dominant while HTTP/3 scaling accelerates.

Latest protocol snapshot



HTTP/3 trend (support)



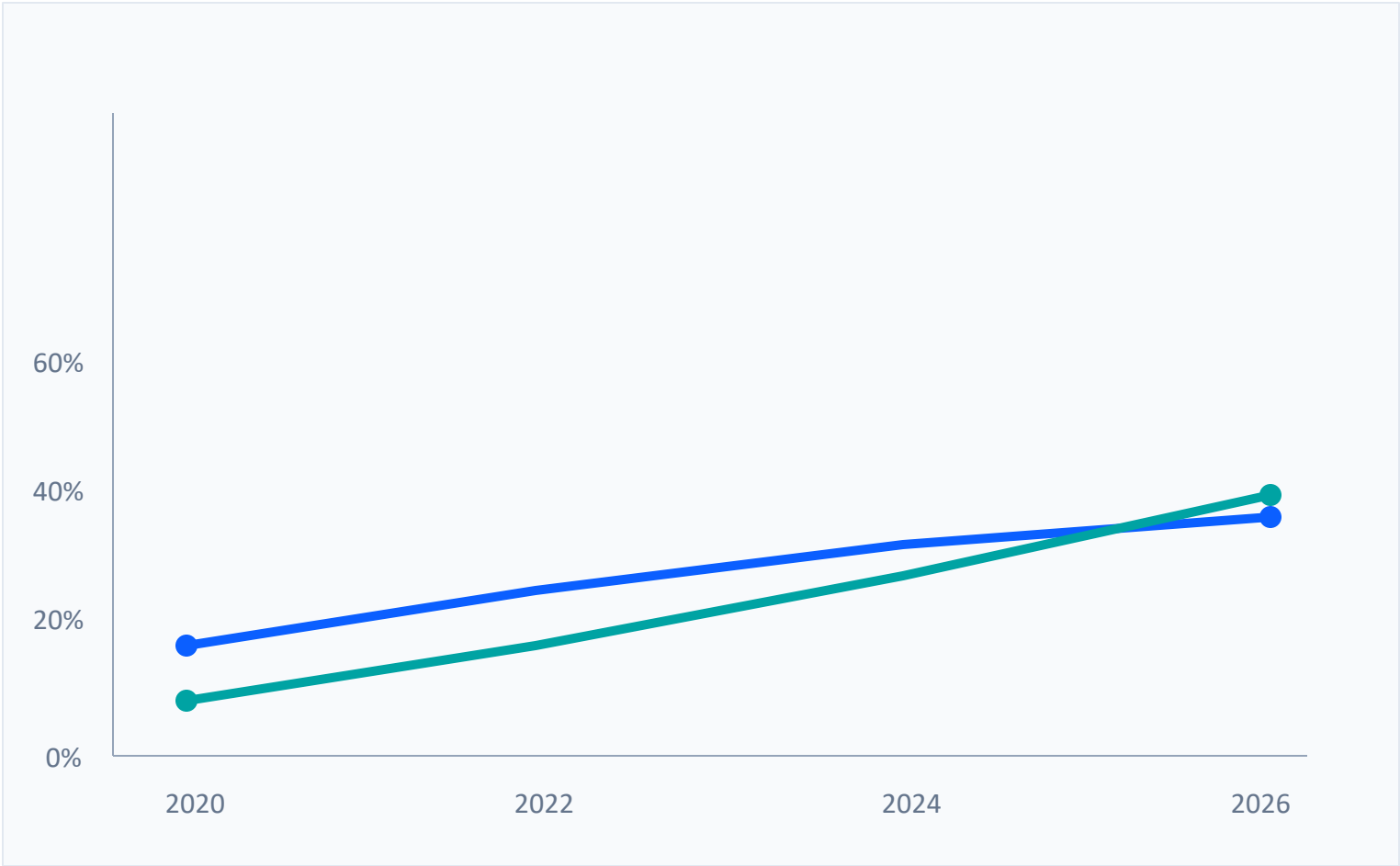
Caveat

HTTP Archive reports HTTP/3 support, not first-connection usage. Fresh Chrome often starts on HTTP/2 before Alt-Svc enables HTTP/3 path selection.

HTTP/2 recent growth: modest (1–3%).

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

Adoption improves FOIT resilience, but most pages still do not declare font-display.



Latest adoption

Desktop: 40.1%

Mobile: 42.5%

Since 2020: +14.9% (D), +61.0% (M)

Why it matters

font-display reduces FOIT risk during webfont fetch and render.

More than half of pages still lack it.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

1. Median desktop page weight is ~2,000 KB, about +25% vs 2020.
2. HTTPS is effectively universal at 99%+ of requests.
3. HTTP/3 support rose from near-zero to ~40%.
4. TCP connections/page fell to 12 (desktop) and 11 (mobile).
5. font-display adoption (~40–42%) still leaves major headroom.

Call to action: Benchmark your own sites against these baselines and prioritize payload, proto